

CHISEL-TEETH LIZARDS

Common in Africa, southern Asia, and Australasia, the small lizards of the family Agamidae – which also includes flying lizards and water dragons – are the Old World equivalents of the iguanas. Spines, flaps, and crests often adorn the head and back of these lizards, which lay soft-shelled eggs. Males are brightly coloured while the females are duller.

ORIENTAL GARDEN LIZARD

Calotes versicolor

This agile, diurnal lizard is often found hunting insects in trees around human habitation. It is common in S. Asia.

long tail helps with balance when climbing

40 cm
16 in

1 m
3¼ ft

AUSTRALIAN WATER DRAGON

Intellagama lesueurii

The largest water dragon in Australia, this species lives beside water into which it dives to escape predators. Adults eat invertebrates and small vertebrates.

1 m
3¼ ft

long limbs

long, laterally flattened tail used in swimming

ASIAN WATER DRAGON

Physignathus cocincinus

A powerful swimmer, this lizard seeks refuge in water when threatened. It is found in riverside trees in S. Asia.

40 cm
16 in

NORTH AFRICAN MASTIGURA

Uromastyx acanthinura

This herbivorous lizard inhabits the harsh desert environments of N. Africa. It uses its club-like, spiny tail in defence.

26 cm
10 in

BOULENGER'S PRICKLENAPE

Acanthosaura crucigera

This slow-moving lizard from Asia preys on insects while perched on a branch. Males use the long spines on their neck when fighting each other.

chisel-shaped teeth on outer rim of mouth

CENTRAL BEARDED DRAGON

Pogona vitticeps

Found in arid woodland in Australia, this lizard has a beard of spines. It lays eggs in an underground nest.

50 cm
20 in

20 cm
8 in

GREEN-STRIPED TREE DRAGON

Diploderma splendidum

This colourful lizard is from humid montane forests of China, where it hunts insects. It lays small clutches of five to seven eggs.

15–18 cm
5–7 in

THORNY DEVIL

Moloch horridus

This Australian lizard feeds exclusively on ants. The body is covered with large, thorny spines, which make it difficult for a predator to swallow. The spines also channel rainwater or morning dew into its mouth.

90 cm
35 in

FRILLED LIZARD

Chlamydosaurus kingii

Common in subtropical woodland in Australia, this species feeds on insects and other lizards in trees and on the ground. When threatened, it unfurls its frill and opens its mouth wide.

strong hind legs allow this lizard to run away bipedally

40 cm
16 in

RAINBOW LIZARD

Agama agama

This common, insectivorous lizard from Africa is grey at night, but becomes brightly coloured in sunlight. Males use their bright skin colours during territorial disputes.